

GODDESS OF WAR AND WISDOM

Athena was born from Zeus's head, in full armor. As the goddess of war and wisdom, she was responsible for the planning of battles.

Her father, Zeus, tried to give her hand to Hephaestus, but she refused to marry anyone.

PARENTS: Zeus and Metis

CHILDREN: None

SACRED SYMBOLS



OWL

Athena was often seen with an owl, which represented wisdom.



OLIVE TREE

Athena introduced the olive tree to Greece. Olives were eaten and used to make oil.



DISTAFF

This is a stick that wool was wound around. It symbolized Athena's reputation as the best weaver.



SPEAR

Athena was always shown carrying a spear, which represented her skill in battle.

ATHENA OF ATHENS

Athena was the main goddess of Athens. The Greeks believed she fought Poseidon for control of the city and was chosen by its citizens when she gave them an olive tree. Olives were an important trade crop for the Athenians.

